

[Return to Search](#)

Original Page: 303

Culture (OWC): [Akan \(FE12\)](#)

Region: Africa

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Section Title(S)

ADDITIONAL NOTES ON TWI USAGE. * AFFINITY TERMS USED BY BOTH SEXES.

FIG. 2.

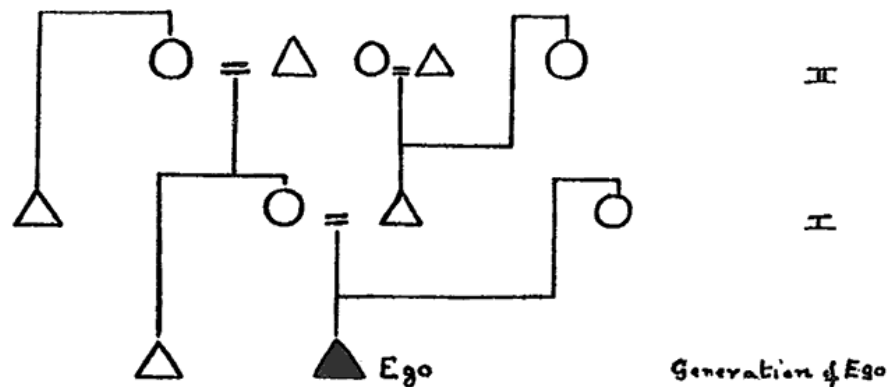


Diagram showing resultant
ranking of brother by sister
△ = males ○ = females

FIG. 2.

601
[Kinship Terminology](#)

A comparison of the tables of consanguinity and affinity of these Twi and Ashanti systems affords a most interesting instance of the way two peoples have taken the same basic kinship terminology and bent it to their peculiar uses. The terms are the same, the usages of every-day speech are practically the same, and yet a close analysis of the strict usage of each system reveals a fundamental difference in preoccupation, a widely divergent although not completely antithetical emphasis.

184
[Cultural Participation](#)

601
[Kinship Terminology](#)

ADDITIONAL NOTES ON TWI USAGE.¹

According to our informant, the terms *nana* for elders and *ba* for those individuals considerably younger than the speaker were in general use. *Wofa* and *osewa*, for mother's brother and father's sister and *adya* and *ena* for father and father's brother, mother and mother's sisters, etc., were used as terms of address. Where, however, a member of one of these two latter categories was younger than the speaker, personal names were used instead. Names were used entirely between members of the same generation.

601
Kinship Terminology

Okrafo, not strictly a relationship term, is used between the two wives of one husband, and also between the wife of a nephew and the wife of his maternal uncle.

601
Kinship Terminology

Joking and chaffing are permitted between brothers and sisters, between a man and his wife's sister, and between a woman and her husband's brother.

602
Kin Relationships

¹ These scattered notes are included for what they may be worth. They were collected incidentally, upon the record of only one informant, and could not be checked as thoroughly as could the relationship terms.

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